

MONEY RULES CONCLUSION

The first time you write your Money Rules, it's really hard—how are you supposed to limit your rules to just ten?! Inevitably, most people's first draft almost always looks something like this:

"Economy seats on a plane!"

"Only order water when I eat out!"

"Don't buy a new phone! Hold on to the old one!"

Do you notice how all these rules are focused on what *not* to do with money? The psychology here is fascinating: Most people don't realize that their fundamental Money Lens is one of restriction. Even when creating *their* own Money Rules, they limit themselves!

Don't do this. Those types of rules are bound to fail—because they're depressing, boring, and inhibiting. I'm looking at those rules right now and I hate them! Money Rules should be permissive, freeing, and exciting. They should inspire, not restrict you.

For example, my rules let me donate to a friend's charity without ever questioning it. I'm inspired . . . by my own rule! (Hold on, let me stop writing for a second. I need to pat myself on the back.)

This is the kind of confidence I want for you. I want you to have thought so deeply about your money attitudes and behaviors that you create a cohesive, thoughtful set of Money Rules to help guide your life—and I want you to *love* them.

Now to be able to spend extravagantly on the things we love, we have to make sure that our rules include some discipline. For example, my first rule is "Save 10 percent, invest 20 percent of gross annual income," which reminds me that long-term discipline matters.

Here's a strategy to help you do it: Plot your rules in the Money Rules Grid. I'll show you some of mine.

	SHORT TERM	LONG TERM
Accumulation	<i>Save 10% of gross income</i>	<i>Invest 20%</i>
Spending	<i>No limit on spending for health or education</i> <i>Never question spending on books, appetizers, health, or friends' fundraisers</i>	<i>Be able to pay in full for large expenses</i> <i>Buy the best and keep it as long as possible</i>